

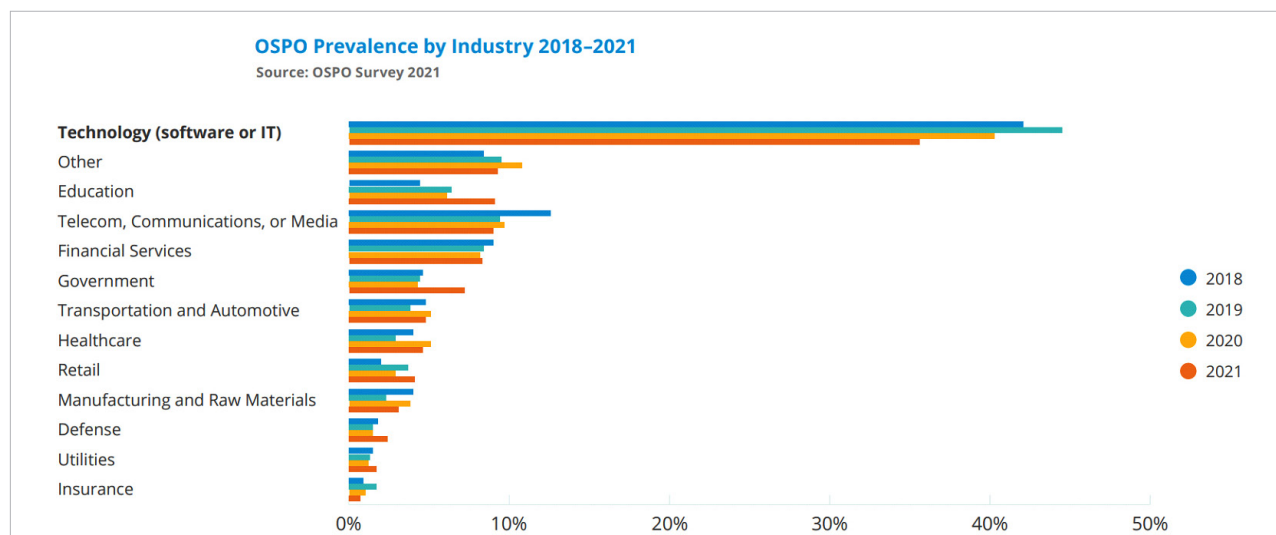


Figure 1: OSPO prevalence by industry 2018-2021 (Source: <https://github.com/todogroup/osposurvey/tree/master/2021>)

connect workflows. This includes ensuring that policies and tools are implemented in a developer-friendly manner.

- **Legal support:** Legal support can come from outside the firm or in-house, but is an important part of an OSPO. The legal role works closely with the program manager to define policies that govern OSS use, including which open source licences are allowed for each product, how to (or whether to) contribute to existing open source projects, and so on.
- **Product and engineering teams/developers:** The engineering team should be well-versed with open source licence(s) and their associated risks. The team must seek approval from the OSPO before consuming any open source component. The team may have to be trained with respect to open source compliance basics and its usage at regular intervals
- **CTOs/CIOs/stakeholders:** A company's leadership has a huge impact on the OSPO strategies. The stakeholders have a great say in the decision making process for any product/solution's delivery. Due to the nature of the OSPO's

function within a company, the VP of engineering, CTO/CIO, or chief compliance/risk officer must get involved in the OSPO.

- **IT teams:** Having support from the IT department is very important. An OSPO may be tasked with implementing internal tools to improve developer efficiency, monitor open source compliance, or dictate open source security measures. IT teams are key in helping to connect workflows, and ensure policies are implemented in a developer-friendly manner. In the 2021 State of OSPO Survey conducted by the TODO Group, the key findings were:
 - There are many opportunities to educate companies about how OSPOs can benefit them.
 - OSPOs had a positive impact on their sponsor's software practices, but their benefits differed depending on the size of an organisation.
 - Companies that intended to start an OSPO hoped it would increase innovation, but setting a strategy and a budget remained top

challenges to their goals.

- Almost half of the survey participants without an OSPO believed it would help their company, but of those that didn't think it would help, 35 per cent said they haven't even considered it.
- 27 per cent of survey participants said a company's open source participation is very influential in their organisation's buying decisions. The use of open source software when building any software solution is almost inevitable today. However, the open source licence risks cannot be overseen. What is needed is a strategic streamlining process that helps combat the compliance issues that come in the way of using open source components effectively.

An OSPO helps set a regulatory culture by building a centralised dedicated team that educates employees and brings awareness regarding everything related to open source usage in an organisation. An OSPO can also work as a guide to fetch top talent from the industry, which will eventually be a boon for business goals. **END** 🐧

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